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Reddit lost 1M+ search visits a week.



And its CEO blames AI Mode.

Steve Huffman, Reddit CEO

Sources: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4 · Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out and recoloured

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It's in Reddit's own shareholder letter.

sec.gov · Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders

Our search referral traffic was down meaningfully in Q3, with the decline accelerating later in the quarter. The biggest impact was on logged-out and web traffic, but some of the impact flows through to logged-in and App traffic, since search referral is a common source of reengagement for users. The company helped to offset the declines by both driving reach primarily through user marketing and also by continuing to improve the product. These declines have continued into the early part of Q4. During October, we have seen that search traffic has dropped by more than 1 million referrals on average per week. If this rate of decline continues, current trends would suggest that total DAUqs could fall in Q4, by a low-double-digit percentage from our current base of 130 million DAUqs.

Page 4. The biggest hit: logged-out web traffic.

Source: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4

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AI Mode "does not drive traffic."



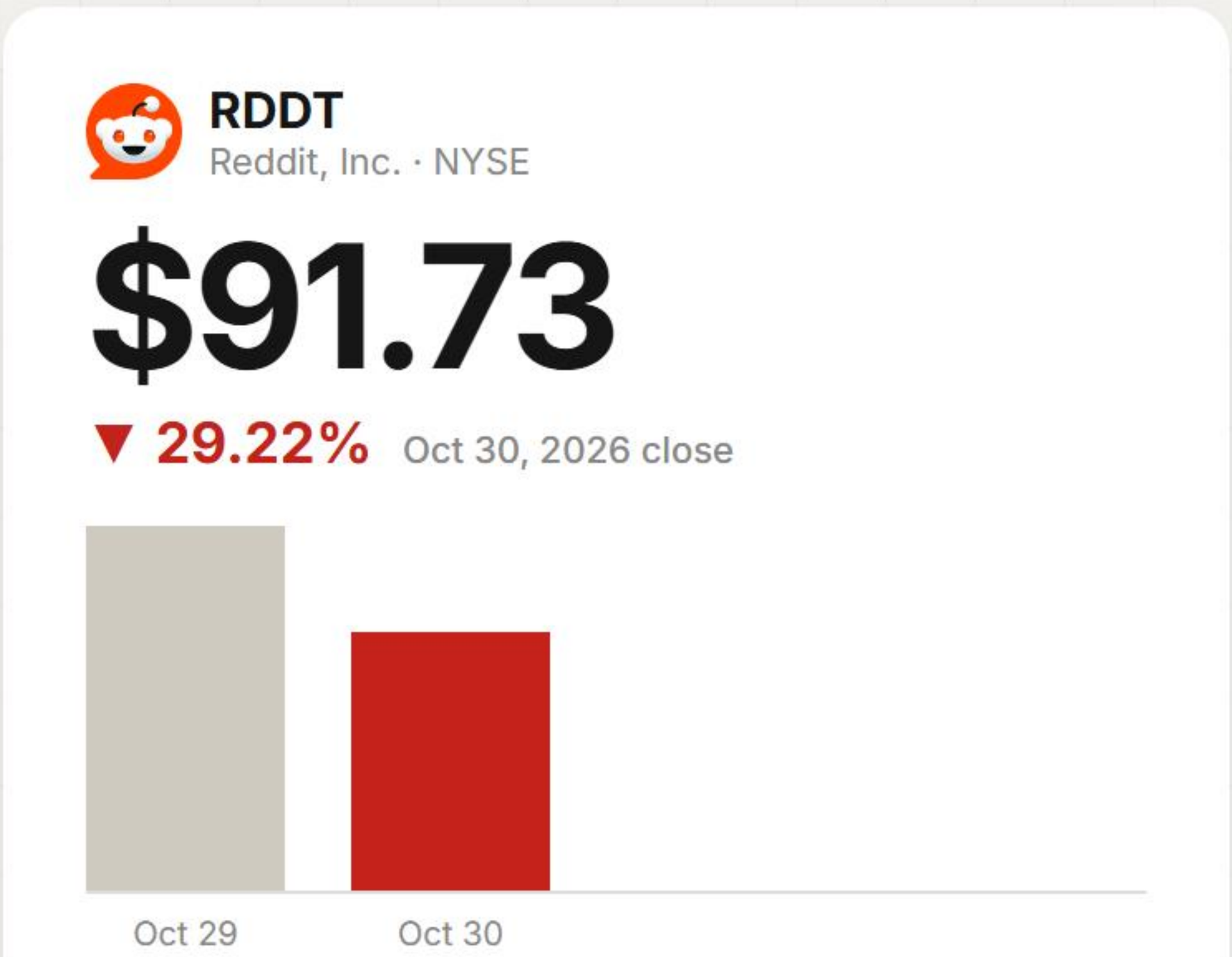
Steve Huffman

CEO, Reddit · Q3 earnings call

Source: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out and recoloured

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The next day, Reddit's shares fell 29%.



Its biggest one-day drop ever.

Source: The Globe and Mail, Oct 30, 2026

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Google still crawls Reddit "as hard as ever."



The answer uses the thread. The click never comes.

Quote: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call) · Search page drawn by TMV to show the idea

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Stop counting only clicks. Track the answer.

What an AI answer can give you

- ✓ Your brand named in the answer
- ✓ Your page cited as a source
- ✗ A visit to your site (not always)

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Do AI answers name your brand?

you

CHECK

Comment **CHECK** and we'll send you our free AI visibility checker.

Reddit × Google